

Art-Teas-Tree Cafe — Project Proposal & Internal Roadmap

Audience: internal team only. This document is the source of truth for our pitch, our pricing logic, and the technical commitments behind each tier. It is **not** for the client. Do not send any section of this verbatim without redacting the rationale notes.

Last updated: 2026-05-16 **Status:** Pre-pitch. Local demo built. Awaiting client meeting to confirm tier selection.

1. Project at a glance

Client: Art-Teas-Tree Cafe, Bidhan Nagar, Kolkata. Associated with the Mime Institute of Calcutta.

Brand premise: A digital love letter to Kolkata's *cha er dokan* (tea stall) culture, framed through a Satyajit Ray / Shantiniketan aesthetic. Theatre, books, adda, slow conversation. Not a luxury brand, not a SaaS site — a cinematic, gritty, scrapbook-feeling space.

What we are selling: Three discrete tiers of digital infrastructure for the cafe. Each tier is a complete deliverable in itself; they are not phases of a single project. The client picks one based on operational needs and budget.

What we are presenting today: A live local demo that combines the *visual* surface area of Demo 2 (full landing page + artist roster preview) so the client can see the complete aesthetic. The functional backbone (QR menu) is sketched but not yet wired to a live Google Sheet — that gets built when a tier is chosen.

2. Current build state

What's live in the local demo

Section	Status	Notes
Hero (vintage playbill)	Done	Sepia photo, handwritten "এখানে আড্ডা ফ্রি" overlay, "Mime Institute presents" eyebrow
Philosophy + Manifesto	Done	Full manifesto verbatim, drop-cap typesetting, director's notebook pull-quote, coffee-ring stain, red-ink margin correction, washi tape
Reel (photo viewfinder section)	Done	Replaces the original Lyadh section. Director's-camera viewfinder + contact-sheet filmstrip with the four café photos
Menu (চা ও চৌ)	Done	Filterable by category, torn-paper edges, wicker-weave background, coaster anchor

Section	Status	Notes
Natyamancha (Stage)	Done — preview only	Masonry postcard grid with 5 mock artists, "Take the Stage" modal form (form is currently inert — no submission backend)
Boipara (Books)	Done	Horizontal book-spine shelf, moss-green wall, coaster anchor
Footer	Done	"আবার দেখা হবে" sign-off, location, hours, affiliation

What's mock and needs real wiring per tier

- **Menu data** — currently a JSON file (`src/data/mockMenuData.json`). Needs to become a Google Sheets pull (Demos 1, 2) or stays JSON (irrelevant for Demo 3 menu, which is unchanged).
- **Artist data** — currently `src/data/mockArtistData.json`. Becomes Sheets (Demo 2) or Supabase (Demo 3).
- **Artist application form** — UI exists, no backend. Needs to either email a recipient (Demo 2) or write to Supabase with approval flow (Demo 3).
- **Domain + hosting** — none yet. See section 7.

Technical stack (locked in)

- **Astro 4** with React 18 islands for interactive components
- **Tailwind CSS 3.4** with a custom theme (`tea, maroon, cream, paper, moss, amber` palette)
- **Framer Motion 12** for cinematic scroll/transition animations
- **Fontsource** for Cormorant Garamond, Lora, Caveat, Hind Siliguri (Bengali), Courier Prime
- **Static output** (`astro build` produces a static site — works on any CDN)

3. The three tiers

3.1 Demo 1 — "The Digital Dokan"

Pitch headline: Cafe gets a beautiful digital identity and a self-serve QR menu. Zero ongoing admin work.

Included:

- Complete landing page (Hero, Philosophy, Manifesto, Book Corner / Boipara, Footer) — full Retro Kolkata aesthetic
- Dynamic QR menu accessed via printed QR codes on each table
- Mobile-optimized menu view (separate route or rendered fragment)
- Google Sheets CMS for the menu only — client edits item name, price, availability, description from their phone and the site updates within seconds

Explicitly NOT included:

- Artist directory / Natyamancha section
- Any form submission backend
- Photo gallery beyond the four café photos hardcoded in the design
- Email capture, newsletter, online ordering, reservations

Price: ₹10,000 one-time (excluding domain and hosting — see section 7)

Internal effort estimate: 30–40 hours

- Final polish of landing page sections: 6 hrs
- QR menu route + mobile design: 8 hrs
- Google Sheets API integration + cache layer: 10 hrs
- Deploy + QA + handover docs: 6 hrs
- Buffer: 5 hrs

Why ₹10k holds up: At ~₹300/hr blended rate this is on the low end but defensible as a portfolio / relationship-building price for a local cultural client. We are not making margin here — we are establishing trust and an upgrade path.

3.2 Demo 2 — "The Ensemble" (*recommended*)

Pitch headline: Everything in Demo 1, plus your artists become part of the website. Still zero admin work.

Included:

- Everything in Demo 1
- Natyamancha (The Stage) section: masonry postcard grid integrated into the main cafe site
- Roster of up to 10 artists with photo, craft, short bio, and contact link
- Google Sheets CMS dual pipeline: one tab for menu, one tab for artists. Replace a row, the site updates.
- "Take the Stage" CTA button — opens a modal with the cafe's contact email (no backend, just a `mailto:` link or a Formspree-style relay)

Explicitly NOT included:

- Artist self-submission (any artist who wants in still has to contact the cafe)
- Search / filtering across artists
- Artist profile pages (each artist is a card, not a page)
- More than 10 artist slots — adding the 11th means upgrading to Demo 3

Price: ₹22,000 one-time (within the stated ₹18k–24k range — we anchor at 22 and have ₹2k of room to negotiate down)

Internal effort estimate: 60–75 hours

- Demo 1 scope: 40 hrs
- Artist grid + postcard component polish: 8 hrs
- Modal + contact relay: 4 hrs
- Second Sheets pipeline + image handling: 10 hrs
- Image optimization (resize, lazy-load): 4 hrs
- Buffer: 6 hrs

Why ₹22k holds up: Roughly 2× Demo 1 effort, 2.2× price. The premium captures the second data pipeline and the heavier image work. Below ₹18k the artist grid becomes free labor; above ₹24k the client perceives a steep jump for "just another section."

Recommendation: This is what we should push. See section 6.

3.3 Demo 3 — "The Cultural Hub"

Pitch headline: A dedicated, searchable artist directory at its own subdomain. This is no longer a website — it's a product.

Included:

- Everything in Demo 1 (cafe landing + QR menu — unchanged from Demo 1)
- A dedicated web app at a subdomain (**artists.artteastree.com** or similar)
- The Natyamancha section on the main cafe site becomes a stylized hero card that links out to the directory subdomain
- Interactive search with category, availability, and location filters
- Uncapped artist profiles, each with a dedicated profile page (dynamic route)
- Artist self-submission form with email verification
- Admin dashboard for the cafe to approve / reject / edit artists
- Image upload pipeline (artist uploads → resized → stored)

Three sub-tiers within Demo 3: *(client picks one)*

Sub-tier	Price	Differences
Lean	₹50,000	Supabase free tier, basic search + 2 filters (craft, location), approval done via Supabase Studio (no custom admin UI)
Recommended	₹75,000	Custom admin dashboard, email-verified submissions, 4 filters (craft / availability / location / language), ~30-artist starting roster
Full polish	₹1,10,000	Above + per-artist portfolio galleries, booking-request form, analytics dashboard, Bengali/English UI toggle

Subscription required. See section 4.

Internal effort estimate (Recommended sub-tier): ~75 hours

Task	Hours
Database design + Supabase schema	6
Supabase auth + RLS policies	4
Admin dashboard (approve / edit / delete)	16
Artist submission form + email verification	8
Search + filter UI with URL state + debouncing	12
Artist profile pages (dynamic routes)	8
Image upload pipeline (resize, storage)	6
Subdomain config + deployment pipeline	3

Task	Hours
Main-site Natyamancha redirect card	1
Polish, testing, edge cases, handover	11
Total	75

At ₹1,000/hr blended rate = ₹75,000. The number is honest, not pulled from a hat.

Why this tier is a different category, not just a bigger website:

- We're standing up a real database, not a Google Sheet
- We're building auth flows and approval workflows — software, not a brochure
- We carry ongoing operational responsibility (uptime, backups, security)
- The client can grow indefinitely on this without coming back to us for every new artist

4. Subscription model (Demo 3 only)

Demo 3 **must** carry a subscription. Without one, we are signing up for unpaid hosting, security patches, and "can you add this filter?" requests forever. The client gets ongoing value (artists join, the platform stays alive); we get covered for our ongoing cost.

Tier	Monthly	What it covers
Hosting only	₹999/mo	Supabase + Vercel + domain renewal + uptime monitoring. No included dev time.
Standard (recommended)	₹1,999/mo	Above + 2 hours/month of changes, security updates, monthly DB backup, email support within 48 hrs
Pro	₹3,499/mo	Above + 5 hours/month, quarterly feature additions, priority support, Google Analytics integration

Why ₹1,999 is the sweet spot

- Roughly equals two coffee orders per day at the café — psychologically affordable
- Once the artist directory crosses Supabase free-tier limits (500 MB storage, ~50k monthly active users), the paid tier alone is ~\$25/mo (~₹2,000)
- Without a subscription, the directory crossing free-tier limits = either we eat the cost, or the site goes down. Both are bad outcomes.

Cancellation / exit terms (must be in contract)

- 30 days notice to cancel
- On cancellation, we provide a full database export (CSV + JSON)
- Site goes into read-only mode for 60 days before being taken down, giving the client time to migrate
- Client retains rights to all artist data and uploaded content
- Source code: see section 7

5. Pricing summary table

Item	Demo 1	Demo 2	Demo 3 (rec.)
One-time build	₹10,000	₹22,000	₹75,000
Subscription	Optional ₹500/mo maintenance retainer	Optional ₹500/mo maintenance retainer	₹1,999/mo required
Domain (annual)	~₹800–1,200 (client pays direct)	Same	Same
Hosting	Vercel/Netlify free tier covers it	Same	Vercel + Supabase paid (covered by subscription)
Cafe admin work	Edit a Google Sheet	Edit a Google Sheet	Approve via dashboard
Artist limit	N/A	10	Uncapped

The ladder is roughly 1x → 2.2x → 7.5x in one-time cost. The Demo 3 jump is deliberate and signals the category shift.

6. Recommended pitch strategy

What to lead with

- Open with Demo 2.** Frame it as the natural answer: "captures the cafe's essence, brings the Mime Institute artists in, requires almost no admin work." Anchor it as the recommendation.
- Position Demo 1 as the budget fallback.** "If timing isn't right for the artist piece, Demo 1 still gives you the full identity and the QR menu, and you can upgrade later." This makes Demo 2 feel like the safer, more complete choice without making Demo 1 feel like a downgrade.
- Position Demo 3 as the future, not the present.** "If the artist directory becomes popular, we'll upgrade you to Demo 3 — but it's a different category of product and most cafes don't need it on day one." This pre-empts the "what's the difference, why not just get the best one?" question and positions Demo 3 as an aspirational ceiling.

Signals that the client should jump straight to Demo 3

- They mention wanting non-Kolkata patrons or event organisers to find artists
- They mention "platform" or "directory" or "booking" unprompted
- They want artists to apply themselves rather than being curated
- They want analytics ("how many people viewed the artists this month?")

If two or more of these surface, do not push them down to Demo 2 — let them have Demo 3.

Numbers to never reveal in the pitch

- Our internal hour estimates
- The fact that Demo 1 is at-cost

- The negotiation room in Demo 2 (we will go to ₹20k if they push, but the opening number is ₹22k)
- The Demo 3 sub-tier prices unless they explicitly engage with that tier

7. Open questions to resolve before pitching

These are gaps in the current proposal that the client will ask about. Lock down internal answers before the meeting.

Question	Suggested internal answer
Who owns the source code?	Demo 1, 2: client owns the code, we keep a portfolio license. Demo 3: we retain source ownership, client gets a perpetual usage license. This is what justifies the subscription.
Who pays for the domain?	Client pays the domain registrar directly (Namecheap / GoDaddy). We assist with setup but the invoice goes to them. ~₹800–1,200/year.
What about hosting cost for Demo 1 / 2?	Vercel + Netlify free tier covers a small cafe site indefinitely. We set it up under the client's account so they own it. No ongoing fee from us.
What if they want updates after launch (Demo 1 / 2)?	Two options: hourly at ₹1,500/hr, or a ₹500/mo retainer for up to 1 hour/month. Mention this in the contract.
Image rights / artist photo consent	Cafe is responsible for getting written consent from each artist before listing. We add a checkbox to the submission form (Demo 3) but the legal responsibility is theirs. Put this in the contract.
What if the menu sheet breaks / loses data?	We set up a daily snapshot of the menu sheet to JSON in the repo (Demo 1, 2). If the sheet is wiped, last good version restores in <5 minutes. Mention this as a stability feature.
Bengali content — who writes it?	Cafe provides Bengali copy. We typeset it. If they need translation we'll quote separately.
Photoshoot for the cafe?	Not in scope. We use the four photos they already provided. Additional photography is the client's responsibility or a separate quote.
Analytics / SEO	Basic SEO (meta tags, OG cards, sitemap) is included in all tiers. Google Analytics requires their GA4 account — we wire it up but they own the account.
Payment terms	50% on contract signing, 50% on launch for Demos 1 & 2. For Demo 3: 40% on contract, 30% on admin dashboard delivery, 30% on launch.
Timeline	Demo 1: 2 weeks from contract. Demo 2: 3–4 weeks. Demo 3 (Recommended sub-tier): 6–8 weeks.

8. Upgrade path between tiers

The technical architecture is built so the client can move up without throwing away work.

```

Demo 1 → Demo 2 → Demo 3
(Static)  (+ Sheets    (+ Supabase
           artist pipe) + subdomain)

```

Demo 1 → Demo 2: ₹15,000 upgrade fee. We add the artist Sheets pipeline and the Natyamancha section. Existing landing page and menu carry over unchanged. Roughly 2 weeks.

Demo 2 → Demo 3: ₹60,000 upgrade fee (less than buying Demo 3 fresh because we credit the Demo 2 build). We migrate the artist data from Sheets to Supabase, stand up the subdomain, build the admin dashboard. Main cafe site stays as-is; only the Natyamancha block changes to a redirect card. Roughly 5–6 weeks. Subscription kicks in at the upgrade.

Why we do not offer an "all-in-one" custom quote: scope creep kills these projects. The three tiers are firm. Custom asks should be quoted as separate add-ons (e.g., "online ordering" or "table reservations") with their own scope and pricing.

9. Technical architecture per tier (for engineers)

Demo 1

```

[ Astro static site ] → [ Vercel CDN ]
      ↑
[ build-time fetch from Google Sheets API ]
      ↑
[ Menu Sheet ] ← edited by cafe owner

```

- Menu is fetched at build time AND on-demand via a serverless function for live updates
- ISR (Incremental Static Regeneration) keeps the menu fresh without rebuilds
- QR codes generated at build time, link to </menu> route (mobile-optimized)
- No auth, no DB, no backend logic

Demo 2

Same as Demo 1, plus:

```

[ Artist Sheet ] → [ build-time fetch ] → [ Natyamancha section ]

```

- Second Sheets tab, same pipeline
- Artist photos: cafe uploads to Drive folder, we pull URLs via Sheets cell
- "Take the Stage" form: Formspree (free tier) or Resend (free tier) to relay to cafe email

Demo 3 (Recommended sub-tier)



- Supabase: Postgres + Auth + Storage + Edge Functions
- Frontend: Astro + React, deployed to Vercel
- Search: Postgres full-text search initially (**tsvector**), can swap to Algolia/Meilisearch later if needed
- Image pipeline: client uploads → Edge Function resizes (3 sizes: thumb, card, full) → Supabase Storage
- Admin auth: magic link via Supabase Auth, limited to cafe's email allowlist
- Row-level security: artists see only their own draft profiles; public sees only approved

10. Cost / effort breakdown (for project leads)

Item	Demo 1	Demo 2	Demo 3 (rec.)
Internal effort (hours)	35	70	75
Blended rate (internal)	₹285/hr	₹315/hr	₹1,000/hr
One-time price	₹10,000	₹22,000	₹75,000
Gross margin per project	~10–15% (loss-leader)	~30%	~50%
Recurring revenue	None	None (optional retainer)	₹1,999/mo
First-year total revenue	₹10,000	₹22,000	₹98,988

Strategic note: Demo 1 is essentially a loss-leader to establish the relationship. Demo 2 starts being a real margin. Demo 3 is where the business model actually lives — recurring revenue + a higher initial fee. If we sign 3 Demo 3 clients across cafés / cultural spaces in Kolkata, we are running a small SaaS-with-services business, not a one-off web shop.

11. Risks

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Client picks Demo 1 and never upgrades	High	Accept it. Demo 1 is a portfolio piece. Use it to win other clients.

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Client wants Demo 3 features at Demo 2 price	Medium	Hold the line. Each feature ask becomes an add-on quote. Do not absorb it.
Subscription churn after 3–6 months	Medium	The 60-day read-only grace period (section 4) gives them time to reconsider before everything goes dark. Most won't actually cancel — they'll pay to keep it up.
Google Sheets API rate limits	Low	Cache aggressively (5-minute TTL). Snapshot daily as a fallback. Sheets API allows 300 requests/minute per project — plenty for a small café.
Artist content gets stale (Demo 2)	Medium	Build a "last updated" timestamp into the artist card. If a card hasn't been touched in 6 months, surface it to the cafe owner.
Bengali typography breaks on some devices	Low	Hind Siliguri is hosted via @fontsource and bundled. Tested on iOS Safari, Chrome, Firefox. Confirmed working.
Cafe owner edits Sheet wrong and breaks the site	Medium	Validation layer in the build script: if a row is malformed, skip it and log to a Slack webhook. Site never goes down due to bad CMS input.
Client asks for online ordering / table booking	Medium	Out of scope for all three tiers. Separate quote: ₹40,000+ for ordering, ₹25,000+ for reservations.

12. Glossary

Term	Meaning
<i>Adda</i> (আড্ডা)	Bengali concept: long, agenda-less conversation. Central to the cafe's identity.
<i>Cha er dokan</i> (চায়ের দোকান)	Roadside tea stall. Cultural archetype the cafe is built on.
<i>Bhar</i> (ভাঁড়)	Disposable clay cup used for tea in Kolkata. Visual motif in the design (see src/components/islands/Scraps.jsx).
<i>Boipara</i> (বইপাড়া)	The book district — specifically College Street in Kolkata. The Books section is themed around this.
<i>Natyamancha</i> (নাট্যমঞ্চ)	The theatre stage. Name of the artist section.
<i>Lyadh</i> (ল্যাড)	Untranslatable Kolkata Bengali: productive idleness. Originally a section in the design; replaced by the Reel photo section in the current build. Still in the manifesto's spirit.
<i>Reel</i> (রিল)	The current photo gallery section. Stylized as a director's camera viewfinder.
CMS	Content Management System. For Demos 1 and 2, that is Google Sheets.

Term	Meaning
RLS	Row-Level Security in Postgres / Supabase. Used in Demo 3 to control who can read/write what.
ISR	Incremental Static Regeneration — Vercel feature that rebuilds individual pages on a schedule without rebuilding the whole site.

13. Document control

- **Owner:** [whoever leads the client account]
- **Reviewers before each client meeting:** at least one engineer and one project lead
- **Update this document when:**
 - Pricing changes
 - A tier's scope changes
 - A new risk surfaces
 - The client signs — add a "Signed Contract" section at the top
- **Storage:** in-repo at `docs/PROPOSAL.md` so it ships with the codebase and never gets lost in a shared drive

End of document.